

Recruit Holdings Hackathon 2026

Innovation Cup

SEPTEMBER 25-27

San Francisco

Supported by

Google Cloud

OpenAI

indeed

Agenda

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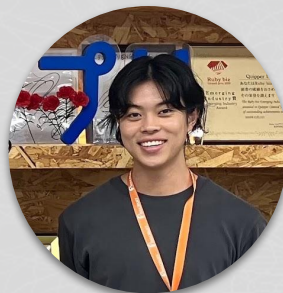
01 Organizing Team & Mentors

Who we are, and who is here to help you

Organizing Team



Shion Kuroda



Sho Adachi



Koki Makino



Shiori Tsujino



Yuriko Wada



Shota Amamoto



Hidetoshi Ebina

Mentor



Hirotaka Moriguchi

Supporters



Jun Sato



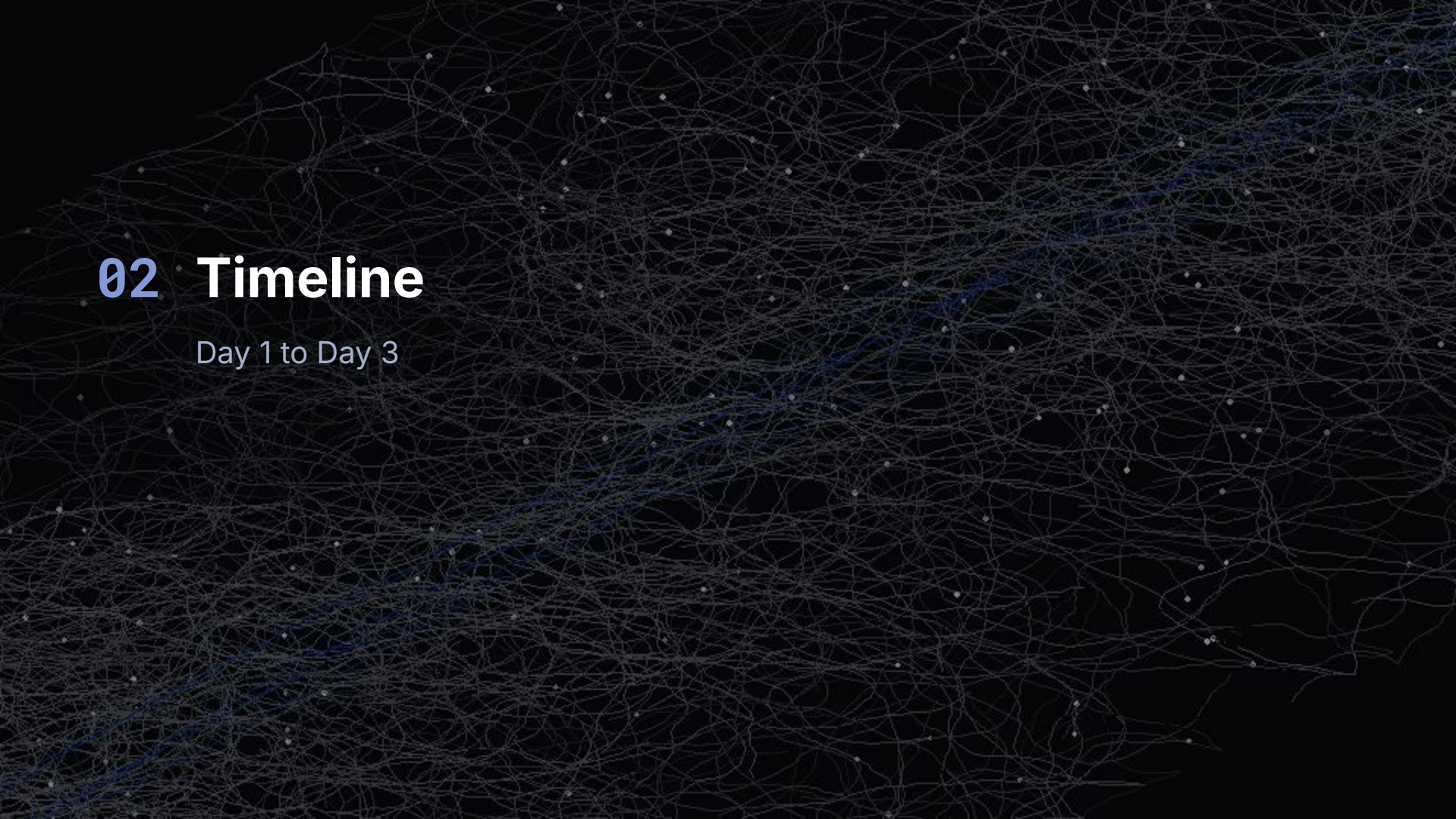
Yuki Kanai



Keisei Okegawa



Ryo Tomiki



02 Timeline

Day 1 to Day 3

DAY 1 Sep 25 (Fri)**4:30 – 5:00 PM****Registration****5:00 – 5:35 PM****Opening Ceremony****5:35 – 6:45 PM****OpenAI / Google Cloud Session****6:45 PM – 0:00 AM****Work begins / Free time**

Venue access available

8:00 – 9:00 PM Tech Support (Core Time)

0:00 – 6:00 AM**Restricted entry/exit**

Direct hotel travel only

DAY 2 Sep 26 (Sat)**6:00 AM – 12:30 PM****Free time**

10:00 – 11:00 AM Tech Support (Core Time)

12:30 PM**Gather****12:30 – 2:30 PM****Lunch / Mentoring Session** **2:30 – 5:00 PM****Work****5:00 – 6:00 PM****Mentoring Session****6:00 – 6:40 PM****Work / Announcements****6:40 PM – 0:00 AM****Work / Free time**

Venue access available

8:00 – 9:00 PM Tech Support (Core Time)

0:00 – 6:00 AM**Restricted entry/exit**

Direct hotel travel only

DAY 3 Sep 27 (Sun)**6:00 – 11:00 AM Free time**

10:00 – 11:00 AM Tech Support (Core Time)

11:00 AM**Submission Deadline**

11:00 – 12:00 PM Presentation prep / Free time

12:00 – 1:10 PM**Lunch** **1:10 – 1:25 PM****Pitch Opening****1:30 – 2:45 PM****Preliminary Judging**

2:45 – 3:00 PM

Break

3:00 – 3:10 PM**Prelim Results & Prep****3:10 – 3:55 PM****Final Judging (3 teams)**

3:55 – 4:20 PM

Break

4:20 – 4:35 PM**Results Announcement****4:35 – 5:00 PM****Judges' Remarks****5:00 – 6:30 PM****Networking Reception** **6:30 – 7:20 PM****Closing Ceremony**

DAY 2 Sep 26 (Sat)

6:00 - 12:30

Free time

12:30

Gather

12:30 - 2:30 PM

Lunch / Mentoring Session 

2:30 - 5:00 PM

Work

5:00 - 6:00 PM

Mentoring Session

6:00 - 6:40 PM

Work / Announcements

6:40 PM - 0:00 AM

Work / Free time

Venue access available

0:00 - 6:00 AM

Restricted entry/exit

Direct hotel travel only



Hiro [Reservation Required] @ Golden Gates (1F)

A thread will be posted today at 7:00 PM, reply to book your 30 min spot

Walk-in @ In front of Amazing Grace (1F)

No reservation needed. Feel free to let us know if you have a mentor preference!

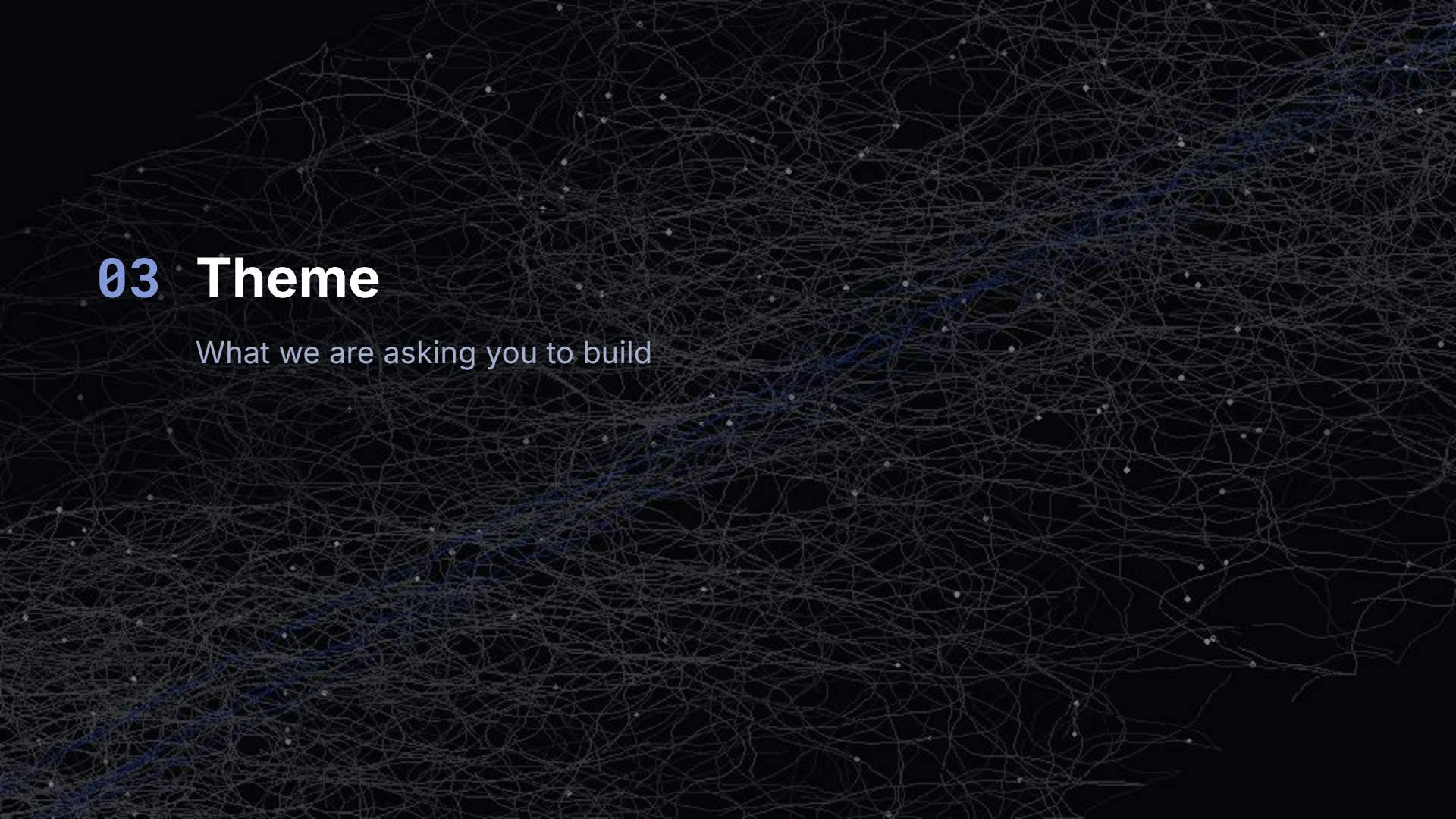


#ask-mentors-techsupporters

Timeline

Technical Support

- OpenAI Technical Support core time : 10:00-11:00AM, 8:00-9:00PM
- Use **#ask-mentors-techsupporters**
- Mention @hojoon @nkhurana @evanroberts



03 · Theme

What we are asking you to build

THEME

***Envision a product
that drives innovation
in the future of **work*****

THEME

Three things to keep in mind

01**"WORK" MEANS EVERYTHING
RELATED TO WORK**

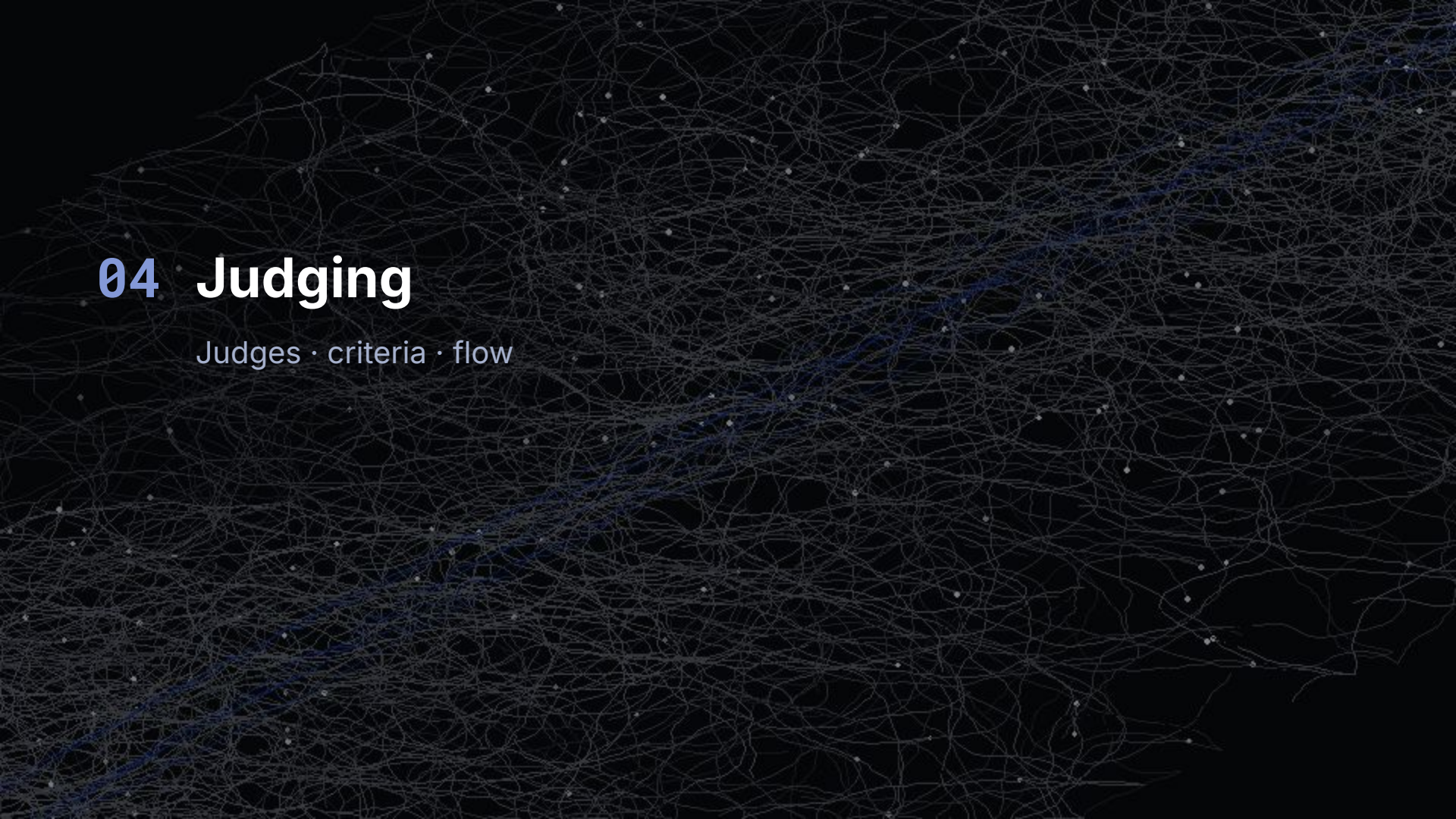
Not just hiring or job hunting —
individuals, teams, organizations,
labor systems and society.

02**NO NEED TO FIT RECRUIT'S
BUSINESSES**

Ask one question: what value
does your product create for
society?

03**AI IS OPTIONAL**

A clear problem, target user and
approach matter more than the
tech stack.



04 · Judging

Judges · criteria · flow

JUDGING

Judging Criteria

Potential Impact	Social Impact	How much value could this create on its own? • Importance and scale of the problem • Potential for meaningful benefits to target users and society • Customer demand and market opportunity • Potential to sustain and grow as a business	40%
	Business Potential		
Creativity & Innovation		Is the insight meaningfully original? • Fresh perspective on the problem • Novel approach or combination • Clear differentiation from existing solutions	30%
Technical Architecture		Is the path to implementation credible? • Technology is appropriate for the problem • System design is clear and realistic • PoC shows that the key technical idea works • Clear path to making the solution work in practice	30%

REMINDERS

Notes

Everything you submit must be built here, during the hackathon

- **Teaming** : Need to change teams on Day 1 (absence etc.)? Consult the organizing team
- **Output must be original and previously unpublished** — no prior submissions or award-winning work
- **No code written before the Opening Ceremony**, no existing self-authored libraries → disqualification
- **Discussing / developing ideas beforehand: OK**
- **Public frameworks & OSS: OK** — follow licenses, disclose substantial third-party components in README

JUDGING

Judges

Global experts from Indeed, Glassdoor, Google Cloud and OpenAI



Jim Giles
CTO, Indeed



Robert Hohman
Co-founder & Former
CEO, Glassdoor



Damien Contreras
Data Cloud Specialist,
Strategic AI, Google Cloud



Ho Joon Cha
Applied AI Architect,
OpenAI

JUDGING

What & when to submit

No changes after the deadline · late = disqualified

Deadline: 11:00 AM PDT, Sunday, September 27

What to Submit:

1. Link to a public GitHub repository
2. Link to a demo or a video of the prototype (Up to 1.5 minutes)
3. Presentation deck as a .pdf format (you can use the format provided in Slack)

Where to Submit:

In #announcements-all channel on Recruit Community Workspace through Slack

JUDGING

Preliminary

Sun, Sep 27 · 1:30–2:45 pm · all teams

3 minutes presentation + 1.5 minutes Q&A

- Keep your presentation and answers as concise as possible
- Monitor below the stage for slides/demos
- Please prepare your PC in advance
- Wait behind the judges during the previous team's turn for smooth transitions
- Order will randomly be selected and shared at 6:30pm on Day 2

JUDGING

Final

Sun, Sep 27 · 3:10–3:55 pm · 3 teams

6 minutes presentation + 6 minutes Q&A

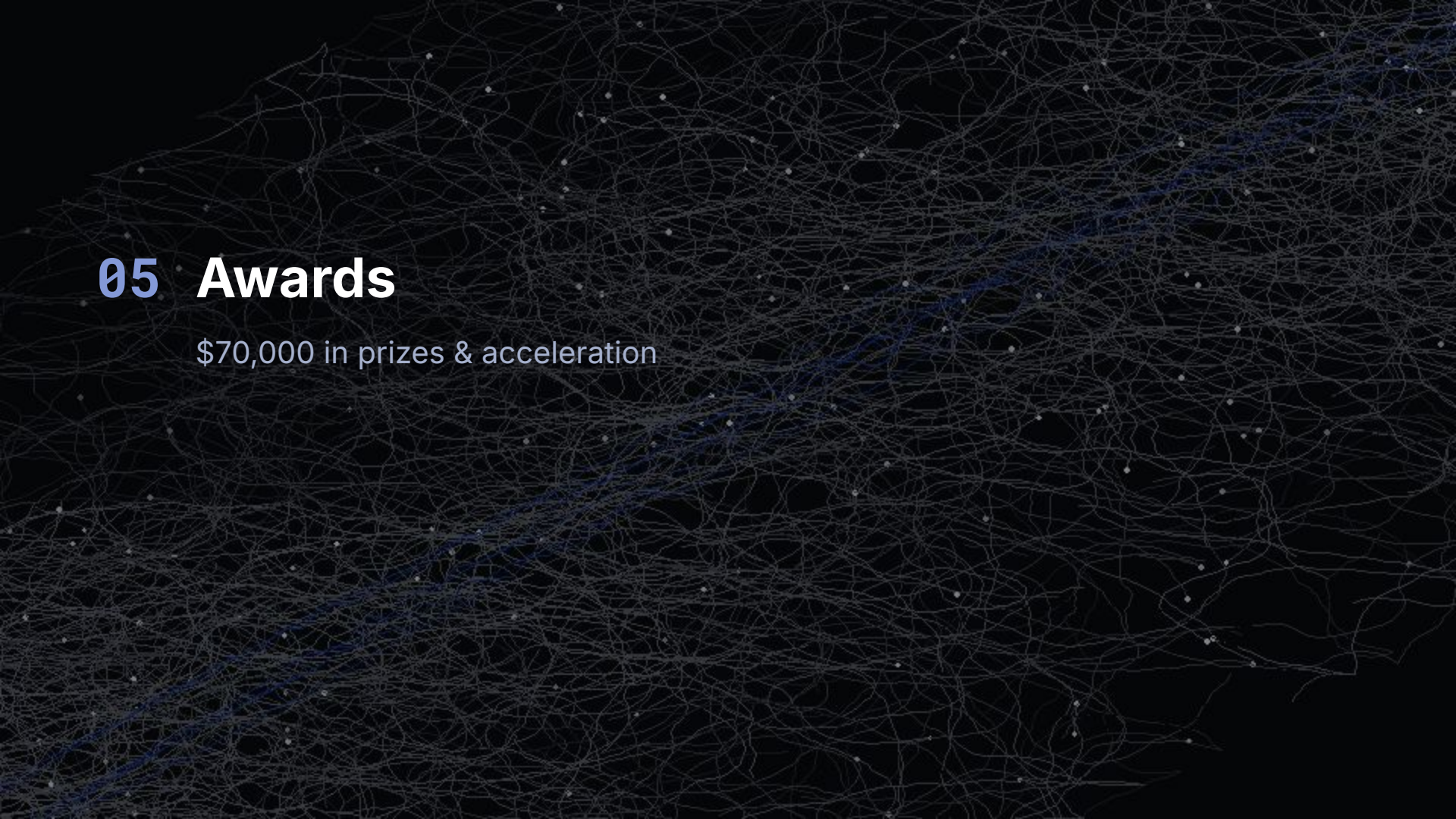
- Same slides/demos from the prelims are allowed, but please add more details
- Present on stage in the order called (use mic & clicker)
- Bring your own PC for projection
- No setup time after the prelim results. Please prepare in advance

1:30 – 2:45 PM Preliminary Judging

2:45 – 3:00 PM Break

3:00 – 3:10 PM Prelim Results & Prep

3:10 – 3:55 PM Final Judging (3 teams)



05 Awards

\$70,000 in prizes & acceleration

AWARDS

Grand Prize

PRIZE MONEY

\$20,000

IF YOU TURN THE PROJECT INTO A BUSINESS

+ \$30,000

ACCELERATION PROGRAM

A 3-month Acceleration Program

- Strategic Mentorship
 - Multiple feedback sessions with active business leaders and interviews with industry experts for deep, real-world insights.
- User Validation (PoC)
 - Opportunities for hands-on product testing and interviews leveraging Recruit's & Indeed's assets and vast corporate network.

AWARDS

SPECIAL AWARD · 2 TEAMS**PRIZE MONEY****\$10,000 each**

Innovation Cup

Date _____

Pay to the order of _____ \$

_____ Dollars

For _____

RECRUIT
Recruit Holdings Co., Ltd.

+ ALL WINNING TEAMS RECEIVE ...

AWARDS

Megagon Labs Catalyst Program

Intensive research program with AI experts

- **Megagon Labs:**
Recruit Group's AI research hub (Mountain View & Tokyo) advancing cutting-edge AI (LLMs, HCI, compound AI, etc.) for real-world impact.
- Intensive program to refine research plans with expert advice from researchers on methodology and AI utilization
- Fully covered flights and hotel expenses for 2 days / 1 night
- Held around January or February, scheduled based on participant availability.



Megagon Labs

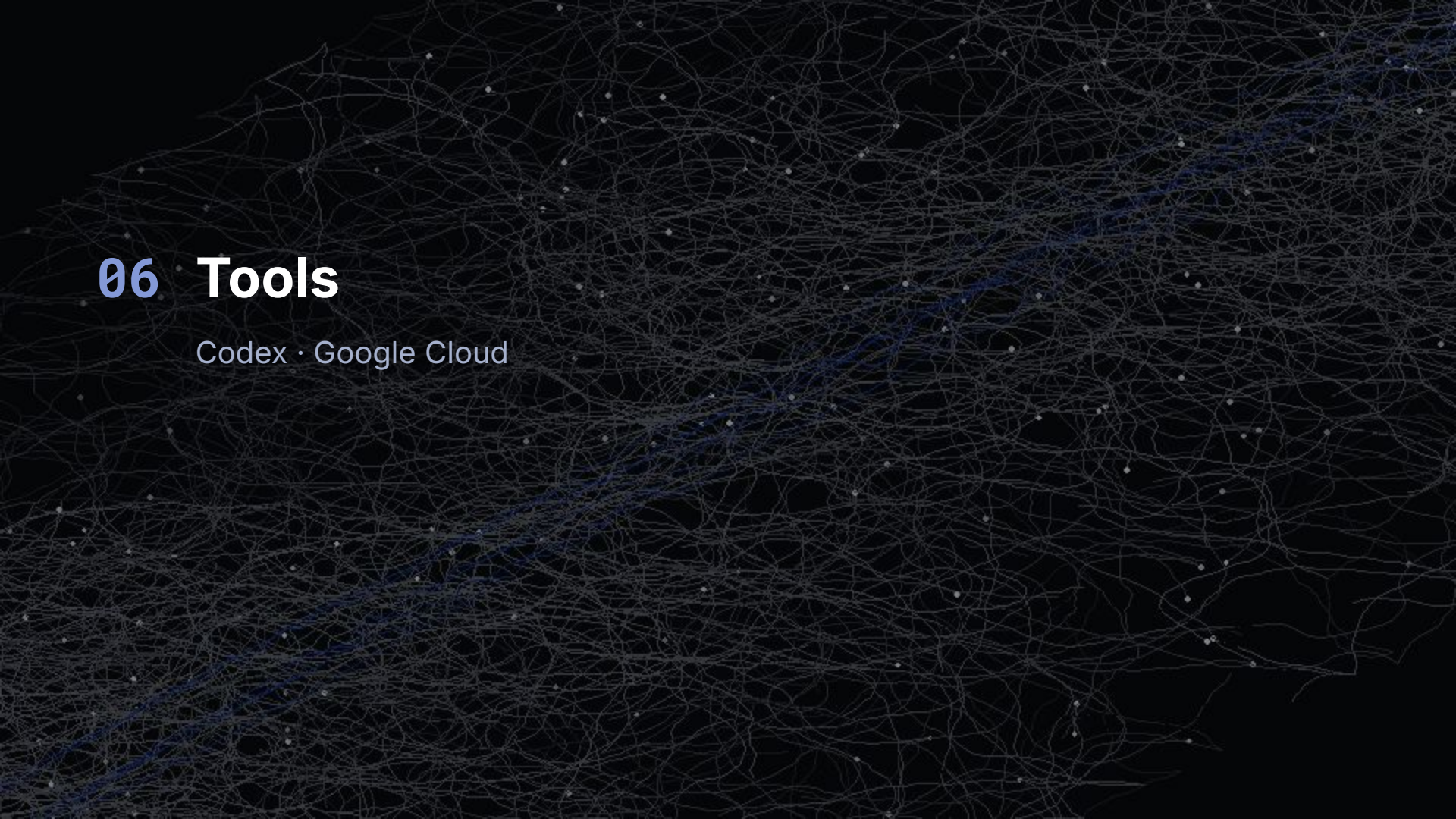
AWARDS

Fast-Track Selection for Dual Internship Program

Cross-border internship in both JP and US

- Paid internship with hands-on work experience in both JP and US
- Deep dive into both Japanese and global mega-markets, experiencing true “CEO-ship” firsthand with immense autonomy
- All members of the winning teams will be eligible for an expedited internship selection process
- Projects and positions are custom-tailored to align with individual skills and aspiration





06 · Tools

Codex · Google Cloud

TOOLS

Codex · Google Cloud

Google Cloud

\$200 in credits per participant

Each team will receive a dedicated Google Cloud project with access to the Gemini API and Google Cloud Storage.

Credits will be allocated to each team's project.

An API key will also be provided to use the Gemini API in your product, if needed.

Codex

\$150 in credits per participant

Each participant will receive a unique redemption link to claim the credits in their personal ChatGPT account.

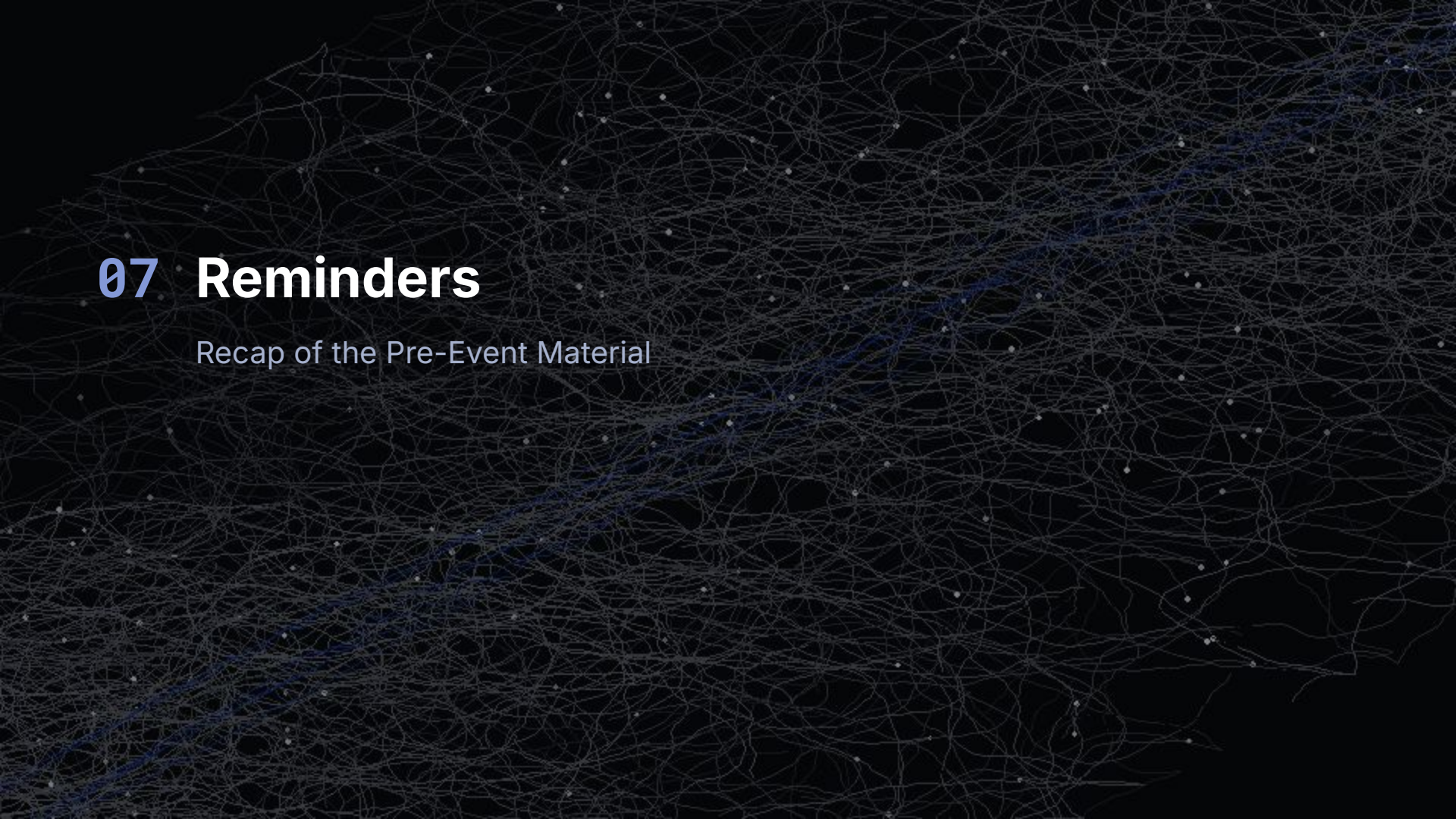
Credits are valid for 4 days from redemption.

TOOLS

Using other tools

Use what you like — at your own risk and expense

- Other AI tools, APIs and paid tools: OK, at your own risk and expense
- Public frameworks & OSS: OK — follow licenses, disclose substantial third-party components in README
- No personal information in prompts
- Don't reuse AI-suggested ideas as-is; don't alter copyrighted works with AI
- Code written before the Opening Ceremony / your own existing libraries: NOT allowed → disqualification



07 Reminders

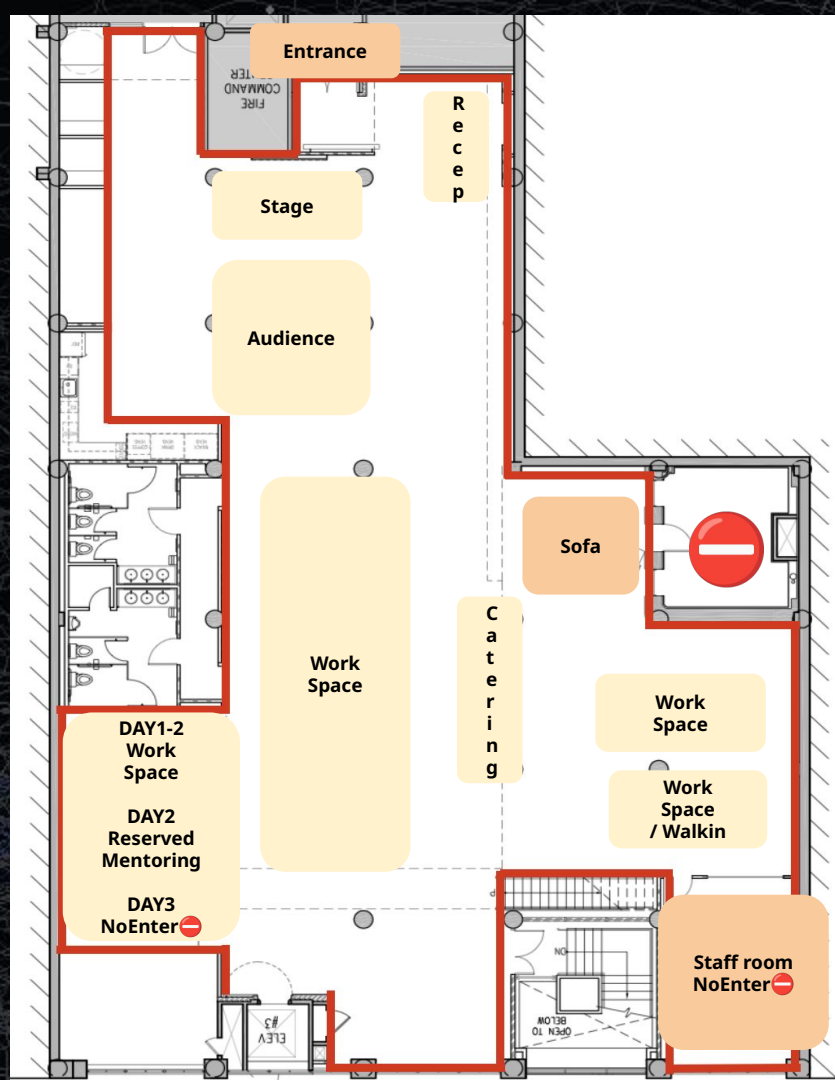
Recap of the Pre-Event Material

REMINDERS

Venue, access & safety

HOURS & SAFETY

- Open 24h
 - no sleeping in the office
 - come and go freely during work hours
- 0:00–6:00: venue $\rightleftharpoons$ hotel only (no going home)
- Red zones off-limits at all times
 - stay east of the venue



REMINDERS

Transportation Expense Reimbursement

- Round-trip travel between your residence and the venue (public transportation, UberX, etc.) is eligible. Please bring your receipts on the final day, as reimbursement will be processed after the event.
- Reimbursement Procedure: Guidance will be provided on the final day of the event. If you wish to receive reimbursement via an overseas bank account, please have your bank account details (SWIFT/BIC, etc.) ready in advance.

REMINDERS

Smoking / alcohol / cannabis · Hotel

SMOKING / ALCOHOL / CANNABIS

- Prohibited for all participants during the event, regardless of age
- No alcohol in the venue

HOTEL USE

- Rooms are private — registered guests only
- No group work in rooms (use the 24h venue)
- Follow the law and generally accepted standards of conduct

REMINDERS

Code of Conduct & Emergency Contact

CODE OF CONDUCT

- **Safe, welcoming, respectful environment — harassment of any kind, incl. sexual harassment, is not tolerated**
- **Examples:** unwelcome comments on appearance / gender / identity · unwelcome physical contact · sexual jokes · pressuring for contact info · repeated 1:1 invitations after refusal · intimidation (shouting, threats, slamming a table)
- **Consequences:** asked to stop, leave, or be excluded from further participation · comply with the T&Cs agreed at registration

EMERGENCY CONTACT

- Feeling unwell, running late, CoC concerns, anything urgent
→ **Slack DM @Shion Kuroda · @Shiori Tsujino · @Yuriko Wada**
- DM, not public channels — handled promptly and discreetly
- Leaving part way through or joining online is generally not permitted

REMINDERS

Social media

Posts about your experience are welcome

- Get consent before posting about anyone identifiable
- You may publish your output (e.g. Devpost) — IP belongs to your team as a joint work

Sharing Your Experience on LinkedIn

- To continue this program and bring this opportunity to future hackers, we would love for you to share your experience on LinkedIn.
- Feel free to tag us and use this hashtag in your post!
 - Recommended Hashtag: #InnovationCup2026 #RecruitHoldingsHackathon
 - Who to Tag: @Career at Recruit Holdings